MHT-CET MBA/MMS
VOCABULARY MASTER GUIDE

List of Words | Words Confused & Misused | Phobias | Manias | Prefixes & Suffixes | Analogies | Synonyms | Antonyms | One Word Substitution | Idioms & Phrases

This guide is arranged according to the vocabulary syllabus headings supplied for preparation. Each topic is explained through definitions, recognition methods, examples, common distinctions, and examination-oriented approaches.

Preparation approach	What to learn
Meaning first	Understand what the word or expression actually means.
Usage second	See how it behaves in a sentence and what words commonly accompany it.
Recognition third	Learn roots, patterns, relationships, and common traps.
Practice last	Apply the knowledge in MCQs, context questions, analogies, and sentence-based questions.

Vocabulary is most useful when a word is learned together with meaning, context, related words, and a realistic example.

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Revision framework

- Learn the definition in one clear sentence.
- Connect it to a familiar Hindi/Hinglish idea where useful, but answer using the exact English meaning.
- Read at least one example sentence.
- Compare close alternatives before moving to the next word.
- Test recall after a gap instead of rereading continuously.

SECTION 2.1 - LIST OF WORDS (22-26)

What this section covers: This section builds the core vocabulary bank. The objective is not only to know a dictionary definition but to recognise how a word behaves in context.

A strong vocabulary entry has seven parts: the word, part of speech, core meaning, Hinglish meaning, example, synonym/antonym, and a common usage note.

How to study a word

- Step 1: Read the word and say it aloud.
- Step 2: Reduce the definition to one simple idea.
- Step 3: attach a familiar Hinglish interpretation.
- Step 4: read the example sentence and identify the context.
- Step 5: connect the word with a synonym or antonym.
- Step 6: note any confusing word with which it is commonly mixed.

Word families

A word often appears in several forms. Recognising the family reduces memorisation and improves sentence completion.

Base word	Noun	Adjective	Verb	Adverb
success	success	successful	succeed	successfully
decision	decision	decisive	decide	decisively
beauty	beauty	beautiful	beautify	beautifully
danger	danger	dangerous	endanger	dangerously

High-value core words

Word	Abundant
Meaning	Present in large quantity
Hinglish meaning	bahut zyada matra mein
Example	The district has abundant rainfall.
Synonym	plentiful
Antonym	scarce
Common trap	Do not confuse abundant with sufficient; abundant means a large amount.

Word	Adverse
Meaning	Unfavourable or harmful
Hinglish meaning	pratikool / nuksan pahunchane wala
Example	The project faced adverse weather conditions.
Synonym	unfavourable
Antonym	favourable
Common trap	Adverse is usually used for things or conditions; a person is generally averse, not adverse.

Word	Alleviate
Meaning	Make something less severe
Hinglish meaning	tez dard ya problem ko kam karna
Example	The new policy may alleviate the pressure on students.
Synonym	relieve
Antonym	aggravate
Common trap	Alleviate reduces severity; it does not mean completely remove.

Word	Ambiguous
Meaning	Open to more than one interpretation
Hinglish meaning	jiska meaning clear na ho
Example	The statement was ambiguous.
Synonym	unclear
Antonym	unambiguous
Common trap	Ambiguous does not mean difficult; it means capable of multiple interpretations.

Word	Benevolent
Meaning	Kind and helpful
Hinglish meaning	dayalu aur bhalaai karne wala
Example	The benevolent donor supported the school.
Synonym	kind
Antonym	malevolent
Common trap	Benevolent is associated with goodwill and kindness.

Word	Candid
Meaning	Honest and straightforward
Hinglish meaning	seedha aur imaandaar
Example	She gave a candid opinion about the proposal.
Synonym	frank
Antonym	evasive
Common trap	Candid does not mean rude; the focus is openness and honesty.

Word	Coherent
Meaning	Logical and well connected
Hinglish meaning	baaton ka logically connected hona
Example	His explanation was coherent and easy to follow.
Synonym	logical
Antonym	incoherent
Common trap	Coherent refers to clear connection among ideas.

Word	Conspicuous
Meaning	Very noticeable
Hinglish meaning	jo easily notice ho jaye
Example	The bright sign was conspicuous from a distance.
Synonym	noticeable
Antonym	inconspicuous
Common trap	Conspicuous means easy to notice, not necessarily attractive.

Word	Diligent
Meaning	Showing steady and careful effort
Hinglish meaning	mehnati aur consistently careful
Example	The diligent student revised every chapter.
Synonym	industrious
Antonym	negligent
Common trap	Diligence is about sustained effort, not simply intelligence.

Word	Eloquent
Meaning	Fluent and persuasive in expression
Hinglish meaning	achhi aur prabhavshali expression wali language
Example	The speaker gave an eloquent address.
Synonym	articulate
Antonym	inarticulate
Common trap	Eloquent normally refers to effective expression, especially speaking or writing.

Word	Frugal
Meaning	Careful with money or resources
Hinglish meaning	paise/resources ko soch samajhkar use karna
Example	She is frugal and avoids unnecessary spending.
Synonym	thrifty
Antonym	wasteful
Common trap	Frugal is not the same as miserly; it can be a positive quality.

Word	Imminent
Meaning	Likely to happen very soon
Hinglish meaning	bahut jaldi hone wala
Example	A severe storm is imminent.
Synonym	impending
Antonym	remote
Common trap	Imminent concerns an event expected soon.

Word	Meticulous
Meaning	Very careful about details
Hinglish meaning	har detail ko bahut dhyan se dekhna
Example	He is meticulous about checking documents.
Synonym	careful
Antonym	careless
Common trap	Meticulous emphasises attention to small details.

Word	Obsolete
Meaning	No longer in use
Hinglish meaning	purana aur ab use mein nahi
Example	The machine became obsolete after the new technology arrived.
Synonym	outdated
Antonym	current
Common trap	Obsolete means replaced or no longer useful in its context.

Word	Pragmatic
Meaning	Practical and focused on workable results
Hinglish meaning	practical aur result-focused
Example	She took a pragmatic approach to the problem.
Synonym	practical
Antonym	impractical
Common trap	Pragmatic is about what works in practice.

Word	Reluctant
Meaning	Unwilling or hesitant
Hinglish meaning	mann na hona / hesitant hona
Example	He was reluctant to accept the offer.
Synonym	unwilling
Antonym	eager
Common trap	Reluctant does not mean unable; the person simply does not want to or is hesitant.

Word	Scrutinise
Meaning	Examine very carefully
Hinglish meaning	bahut dhyan se jaanchna
Example	The auditor scrutinised the records.
Synonym	examine
Antonym	overlook
Common trap	Scrutinise is stronger than simply look at.

Word	Vigilant
Meaning	Watchful and alert
Hinglish meaning	satark aur alert
Example	Security staff remained vigilant throughout the event.
Synonym	alert
Antonym	careless
Common trap	Vigilant describes continued alertness.

Word	Viable
Meaning	Capable of working successfully
Hinglish meaning	jo practically kaam kar sakta ho
Example	The team proposed a viable business model.
Synonym	feasible
Antonym	unworkable
Common trap	Viable is frequently used for plans, options, or systems that can work.

Word	Wary
Meaning	Cautious because of possible danger
Hinglish meaning	savdhan rehna
Example	Be wary of suspicious messages.
Synonym	cautious
Antonym	trusting
Common trap	Wary means cautious; weary means tired.

Context-based understanding

A word can have a slightly different force depending on the sentence. For vocabulary questions, read the entire sentence before selecting an option. A familiar word is not automatically the correct word if its context does not fit.

> Example: "The report was candid" suggests frankness. "The report was ambiguous" suggests that its meaning was unclear. Both may sound like descriptions of a report, but they describe different qualities.

SECTION 2.2 - WORDS CONFUSED & MISUSED (27-31)

These words are often confused because they look similar, sound similar, or are commonly used incorrectly. The safest method is to learn the difference in meaning and the grammatical role at the same time.

> A useful rule is to compare the words in pairs and immediately create one sentence for each.

High-frequency confusion pairs

Words	Difference	Example	Memory cue
Affect / Effect	Affect is usually a verb meaning influence. Effect is usually a noun meaning result.	Lack of sleep affects concentration. The effect was visible.	Affect -> action; Effect -> result.
Accept / Except	Accept means receive or agree. Except means excluding.	She accepted the offer. Everyone came except Arjun.	Ask: receive/agree or leave out?
Advice / Advise	Advice is a noun. Advise is a verb.	He gave useful advice. I advise you to revise.	Advice = thing; Advise = action.
Principal / Principle	Principal can mean head of a school or most important. Principle means a rule or belief.	The principal spoke about discipline. Honesty is a principle.	Principal -> person/main; Principle -> rule.
Compliment / Complement	Compliment is praise. Complement means complete or improve by fitting well.	She complimented my presentation. The colour complements the design.	Compliment = praise; Complement = complete/fit.
Stationary / Stationery	Stationary means not moving. Stationery means writing materials.	The car remained stationary. I bought office stationery.	-ary -> not moving; -ery -> writing materials.
Loose / Lose	Loose means not tight. Lose means fail to keep, misplace, or not win.	The belt is loose. Do not lose your confidence.	Loose has two o letters; lose has one o after l.
Then / Than	Then usually refers to time or sequence. Than is used in comparisons.	Study first, then revise. She is taller than me.	Time/sequence -> then; comparison -> than.
Their / There / They're	Their shows possession; there refers to place/existence; they're means they are.	Their books are there. They're ready.	Replace they're with "they are" to test it.
Your / You're	Your shows possession. You're means you are.	Is this your bag? You're early.	Replace you're with "you are".
Its / It's	Its shows possession. It's means it is or it has.	The company changed its policy. It's ready.	Apostrophe means contraction, not possession.
Desert / Dessert	Desert can mean a dry region or abandon. Dessert is the sweet course after a meal.	They crossed the desert. We ordered dessert.	Dessert has two s letters.
Elicit / Illicit	Elicit means draw out a response. Illicit means illegal or forbidden.	The question elicited a strong response. Illicit trade was reported.	Elicit = obtain a response; illicit = unlawful.

Words	Difference	Example	Memory cue
Emigrate / Immigrate	Emigrate means leave one country to live elsewhere. Immigrate means enter another country to live there.	They emigrated from India. They immigrated to Canada.	From -> emigrate; to -> immigrate.
Farther / Further	Farther generally refers to physical distance. Further often refers to additional extent or figurative progress.	The village is farther than expected. We need further discussion.	Physical distance -> farther; additional -> further.
Fewer / Less	Fewer is used with countable plural nouns. Less is generally used with uncountable nouns.	Fewer students were absent. We have less time.	Countable -> fewer; uncountable -> less.
Historic / Historical	Historic means important in history. Historical means related to history.	It was a historic decision. We studied historical records.	Historic = significant; historical = connected with history.
Lend / Borrow	Lend means give something temporarily. Borrow means take/use temporarily with permission.	Can you lend me a pen? May I borrow your pen?	Direction matters: lender gives, borrower receives.
Lie / Lay	Lie means recline/rest. Lay means put something down and normally takes an object.	I want to lie down. Lay the book on the table.	Lay needs an object: lay the book.
Wary / Weary	Wary means cautious. Weary means tired.	Be wary of scams. After the trip, she was weary.	Wary -> caution; weary -> tiredness.

How to solve a confused-word question

- First decide what the sentence means.
- Then identify whether the blank requires a noun, verb, adjective, adverb, etc.
- Check the exact relation: possession, comparison, result, action, place, time, or legality.
- Eliminate any option that is close in spelling but wrong in meaning.
- Read the completed sentence once more for natural usage.

Common examination trap

The distractor is often a familiar word that is nearly correct. Do not choose an option because it "looks right". The difference must fit the sentence exactly.

SECTION 2.3 - PHOBIAS (32)

The term phobia is used in vocabulary questions for an intense fear or aversion associated with a specific object, activity, place, or situation. For examination purposes, learn the name, the thing feared, and the root that points to it.

> Root-based learning is useful. Once the root is recognised, an unfamiliar term becomes easier to decode.

Phobia	Fear / aversion related to	Root cue
Acrophobia	heights	acro = high
Claustrophobia	enclosed or confined spaces	claustro = enclosed space
Agoraphobia	situations/places where escape or help may feel difficult	agora = open/public place
Arachnophobia	spiders	arachno = spider
Hydrophobia	water	hydro = water
Nyctophobia	darkness/night	nycto = night
Glossophobia	public speaking	glosso = tongue/speech
Xenophobia	strangers/foreigners	xeno = stranger/foreign
Zoophobia	animals	zoo = animals
Thanatophobia	death	thanato = death
Astraphobia	thunder/lightning	astra = celestial phenomena

Important distinction

Phobia indicates fear. Mania indicates excessive preoccupation or an intense urge/obsession in the vocabulary sense. Do not interchange the two.

Example question: Fear of heights is called acrophobia. The quickest route is to recognise acro = high.

SECTION 2.4 - MANIAS (33)

In vocabulary study, a mania refers to an excessive enthusiasm, preoccupation, or compulsive tendency connected with a particular activity or object. Learn the word together with the root and the central idea.

Mania	Meaning / preoccupation	Root cue
Bibliomania	excessive passion for collecting or reading books	biblio = books
Kleptomania	compulsive tendency to steal things	klepto = steal
Megalomania	obsession with power, importance, or grandiosity	megalo = great/large
Dipsomania	abnormal craving for alcohol	dipso = alcohol
Pyromania	compulsive fascination with or urge to set fires	pyro = fire
Graphomania	excessive desire to write	grapho = writing
Erotomania	obsessive preoccupation involving romantic or sexual attraction	eroto = love/desire

Root strategy

- biblio -> books -> bibliomania
- pyro -> fire -> pyromania
- klepto -> steal -> kleptomania
- grapho -> writing -> graphomania

Examination approach

In a multiple-choice question, first identify the object or behaviour in the definition, then match it to the root. This is usually faster than trying to memorise the full word from spelling alone.

SECTION 2.5 - PREFIXES & SUFFIXES (34-36)

A prefix is added to the beginning of a word. A suffix is added to the end. They often change the meaning, grammatical category, or both.

> Example: un + happy = unhappy. Here un- changes the meaning to "not happy". happy + ness = happiness. Here -ness turns an adjective into a noun.

Common Prefixes

Prefix	Usual meaning	Examples
un-	not / opposite	unfair, unhappy, uncertain
dis-	not / opposite / reversal	disagree, disconnect, dishonest
in- / im- / il- / ir-	not	inactive, impossible, illegal, irregular
re-	again	rewrite, reconsider, rebuild
pre-	before	preview, prepay, pretest
post-	after	postgraduate, postwar
anti-	against	antiwar, antibiotic, antisocial
auto-	self	autobiography, automatic
bi-	two	bicycle, bilingual
tri-	three	triangle, tricycle
mis-	wrongly / badly	misunderstand, mislead
co-	together / jointly	cooperate, coauthor
sub-	under / below	submarine, subconscious
super-	above / beyond	superhuman, supermarket
inter-	between / among	international, interact
trans-	across / beyond	transport, transcontinental

Common Suffixes

Suffix	Usual function / meaning	Examples
-ness	state or quality; noun	kindness, darkness, happiness
-ment	result/action; noun	development, achievement
-tion / -sion	action/result; noun	education, decision
-er / -or	person who does something	teacher, actor
-ful	full of	careful, useful, hopeful
-less	without	careless, hopeless, fearless
-able / -ible	capable of being	readable, visible
-ous	having the quality of	dangerous, famous
-ive	having the nature of	active, creative
-ly	usually forms an adverb	quickly, carefully

Negative prefixes: a key distinction

The forms in-, im-, il-, ir- often mean "not", but the form changes according to spelling/sound patterns: impossible, illegal, irregular. Learn the examples as families rather than trying to infer every spelling mechanically.

How to decode an unfamiliar word

- Look at the beginning and identify a possible prefix.
- Look at the ending and identify a possible suffix.
- Use the base word to estimate the central meaning.
- Combine the pieces and test the result against the sentence context.
- Treat the result as a clue, not as an automatic dictionary definition.

SECTION 2.6 - ANALOGIES (37-40)

An analogy asks you to identify the exact relationship between two words and then apply the same relationship to another pair.

> Format: A : B :: C : ? This is read as "A is related to B in the same way that C is related to ?"

Common relationship types

Relationship	Example	Explanation
Synonym	rapid : fast :: tiny : small	The pair has nearly the same meaning.
Antonym	hot : cold :: success : failure	The pair expresses opposites.
Worker : workplace	doctor : hospital :: judge : court	The first person works in the second place.
Worker : tool	carpenter : saw :: writer : pen	The second word is a tool used by the first.
Object : function	knife : cut :: pen : write	The second word states the function.
Animal : sound	dog : bark :: cat : meow	The second word is the characteristic sound.
Part : whole	wheel : car :: page : book	The first word is a component of the second.
Young : adult	calf : cow :: puppy : dog	The first is the young form of the second.
Material : product	gold : jewellery :: wood : furniture	The first is used to make the second.
Cause : effect	exercise : fitness :: study : knowledge	The first contributes to the second.
Degree / intensity	warm : hot :: cool : cold	The relationship is based on increasing intensity.

Method for solving an analogy

- 1. State the first relationship in words. Example: "A is the workplace of B."
- 2. Replace the letters with the actual words.
- 3. Test every option using the same relationship, not a similar-looking relationship.
- 4. Reject options that fit the words individually but not the relation.

Common trap

> The most tempting wrong option often belongs to the same broad category but has a different relationship. For example, if doctor : hospital means "worker : workplace", a medical instrument is not an equivalent answer even though it is related to a doctor.

Practice patterns

Question pattern	Relationship to identify
Bird : Fly :: Fish : ?	animal -> typical movement/action
Book : Read :: Food : ?	object -> function
Day : Night :: Victory : ?	antonym
Wheel : Car :: Finger : ?	part -> whole

SECTION 2.7 - SYNONYMS (41-43)

A synonym is a word that has the same or a closely related meaning as another word. In practice, synonyms are often near-synonyms, not perfect replacements.

> The exam may test a synonym directly or through context. Therefore, the best answer is the option that matches both the meaning and the context.

Levels of synonymy

Type	Explanation	Example
Close synonyms	Mean almost the same thing in many contexts.	rapid - fast
Contextual synonyms	Equivalent in a particular sentence but not always interchangeable.	bright can mean intelligent or shining
Register-based synonyms	Same basic idea but different formality.	help - assist
Intensity-based synonyms	Meaning is related, but emotional strength differs.	angry - furious

High-value synonym families

Word	Useful synonyms
Abandon	leave, desert, forsake
Abundant	plentiful, ample, copious
Accurate	correct, precise, exact
Brief	short, concise, succinct
Cautious	careful, wary, prudent
Commence	begin, start, initiate
Conceal	hide, cover, disguise
Conspicuous	noticeable, prominent, obvious
Diminish	reduce, decrease, lessen
Diligent	industrious, hardworking, assiduous
Evident	clear, obvious, apparent
Fragile	delicate, breakable, vulnerable
Generous	liberal, charitable, magnanimous
Hostile	unfriendly, antagonistic, aggressive
Impartial	fair, unbiased, neutral
Imminent	impending, near, approaching
Lucid	clear, intelligible, comprehensible
Meticulous	careful, painstaking, thorough
Obsolete	outdated, antiquated, outmoded
Pragmatic	practical, realistic, sensible
Reluctant	unwilling, hesitant, disinclined
Resilient	strong, adaptable, tough
Scrutinise	examine, inspect, investigate
Vague	unclear, imprecise, indefinite
Vigilant	alert, watchful, attentive
Viable	feasible, workable, practicable

How to answer synonym questions

- Read the target word in its sentence if context is provided.
- Predict the rough meaning before checking the options.
- Eliminate antonyms first.
- Compare the remaining options for exactness and tone.
- Choose the closest meaning, not merely a related word.

SECTION 2.8 - ANTONYMS (44-46)

An antonym is a word that expresses an opposite or contrasting meaning. Not all opposites work in exactly the same way, so understanding the type of opposition is useful.

Types of antonyms

Type	Explanation	Examples
Binary opposites	Only one of two states generally applies.	alive - dead
Gradable opposites	Opposites lie on a scale.	hot - cold
Relational opposites	The words describe opposite relationships.	buy - sell
Directional opposites	Movement or position in opposite directions.	advance - retreat

High-value antonym pairs

Word	Antonym
Abundant	scarce
Ancient	modern
Artificial	natural
Expand	contract
Permanent	temporary
Optimistic	pessimistic
Generous	stingy
Hostile	friendly
Victory	defeat
Transparent	opaque
Superior	inferior
Maximum	minimum
Include	exclude
Encourage	discourage
Reveal	conceal
Create	destroy
Accept	reject
Flexible	rigid
Complex	simple
Frequent	rare
Vivid	dull
Mandatory	optional
Reluctant	eager
Visible	hidden
Genuine	fake
Expand	shrink

Context matters

A word may have more than one opposite depending on context. For example, light can be contrasted with heavy when weight is meant, or with dark when brightness is meant. Therefore, identify the intended sense before choosing an antonym.

SECTION 2.9 - ONE WORD SUBSTITUTION (47-48)

One Word Substitution replaces a phrase or description with one precise word. These questions reward exact recall, but grouping terms by category makes them easier to organise.

> The phrase should be understood first. The answer must satisfy the whole description, not only one part of it.

People and characteristics

Description	One word	Meaning cue
One who loves books	Bibliophile	biblio = books
One who hates mankind	Misanthrope	mis = dislike, anthro = human
One who loves mankind	Philanthropist	philo = love, anthro = human
One who knows many languages	Polyglot	poly = many, glot = language
One who studies mankind	Anthropologist	anthropology = study of humans
One who studies plants	Botanist	botany = plants
One who studies animals	Zoologist	zoology = animals
One who cannot read or write	Illiterate	literate = able to read/write
One who speaks very little	Taciturn	habitually reserved/sparing in speech
One who speaks many languages	Polyglot	many languages

Beliefs and attitudes

Description	One word
One who believes in God	Theist
One who does not believe in God	Atheist
One who believes in one God	Monotheist
One who believes in many gods	Polytheist
One who is neutral or non-partisan	Impartial

Places

Description	One word
Place where books are kept	Library
Place where aircraft are kept	Hangar
Place where coins are made	Mint
Place where dead bodies are kept for examination	Morgue
Place where animals are kept for public viewing	Zoo

Time and frequency

Description	One word
Happening once a year	Annual
Happening twice a year	Biannual
Happening every two years	Biennial
Happening every day	Daily
Happening every week	Weekly

Important distinction: biannual = twice a year; biennial = once every two years.

More One Word Substitutions

Description	Answer
A person who collects stamps	Philatelist
A person who collects coins	Numismatist
A government by the people	Democracy
A government by a king or queen	Monarchy
A place where scientific experiments are conducted	Laboratory
A person who writes dictionaries	Lexicographer
A person who writes about their own life	Autobiographer
A speech delivered without preparation	Extempore / impromptu speech
A person who looks at the bright side of things	Optimist
A person who expects the worst	Pessimist
A person who loves mankind	Philanthropist
A person who travels from place to place	Itinerant

How to solve One Word Substitution

- Underline the key defining phrase in the question.
- Identify whether it describes a person, place, process, belief, habit, or time period.
- Look for a familiar root when possible.
- Check whether the answer matches every important part of the definition.

SECTION 2.10 - IDIOMS / PHRASES (49-52)

An idiom is a fixed expression whose intended meaning is not necessarily the literal meaning of its individual words. A phrase can be interpreted from context, while an idiom often needs to be learned as a complete unit.

> For example, break the ice does not normally mean to physically break ice. It means to begin a friendly interaction and reduce initial awkwardness.

Important idioms and phrases

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Break the ice	start a friendly conversation or make people feel comfortable	Once in a blue moon	very rarely
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
A blessing in disguise	something that seems bad at first but proves beneficial	Hit the nail on the head	say or do exactly the right thing
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Spill the beans	reveal a secret	Beat around the bush	avoid the main point
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Cost an arm and a leg	be extremely expensive	Under the weather	feel unwell
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Call it a day	stop working for the day	In hot water	be in trouble
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Piece of cake	be very easy	Burn the midnight oil	work or study late at night
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
At the eleventh hour	at the last possible moment	A storm in a teacup	a large reaction to a small issue
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
By leaps and bounds	very rapidly	Keep an eye on	watch or monitor
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Make both ends meet	manage financially with available income	On cloud nine	extremely happy
Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Add fuel to the fire	make a bad situation worse	Bite the bullet	face a difficult situation with courage

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Read between the lines	look for an implied meaning	In the long run	over a long period of time

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
On the same page	share the same understanding	A double-edged sword	something with both advantages and disadvantages

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
The tip of the iceberg	a small visible part of a much larger issue	Go the extra mile	make an additional effort

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Take with a grain of salt	do not accept something as completely true	A piece of the pie	a share of something

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Get cold feet	become nervous about an action you planned to take	Pull strings	use influence to obtain a result

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Turn a blind eye	deliberately ignore something	Cut corners	do something cheaply or carelessly by skipping steps

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Through thick and thin	through good and bad times	In black and white	in writing or in a clear, definite form

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
At loggerheads	in strong disagreement	In the nick of time	just before it is too late

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
By word of mouth	through spoken communication	Keep something at bay	prevent something from coming close or causing harm

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Put off	postpone	Look into	investigate

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Look after	take care of	Give up	quit or stop

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning
Carry out	perform or complete	Bring up	mention or raise a topic

Idiom / Phrase	Meaning	Idiom / Phrase	Meaning

Put up with	tolerate		

Idiom vs literal meaning

Expression	Literal reading	Actual meaning
Break the ice	break frozen water	start a friendly interaction
Spill the beans	drop beans	reveal a secret
Bite the bullet	bite a metal bullet	face a difficult situation bravely
Under the weather	be physically under weather	feel unwell

How to learn idioms

- Learn the complete expression as one unit.
- Attach one clear situation to the idiom.
- Read an example sentence so that the expression becomes contextual.
- Do not translate each word separately while solving the question.

VOCABULARY REVISION SYSTEM

The most efficient revision method is active recall. Close the notes and try to produce the meaning, synonym, antonym, or usage from memory.

1. Daily word cycle

Stage	Task
Read	Learn 10-15 new items with meaning and one example.
Recall	Close the page and say the meanings without looking.
Compare	Review confused pairs and antonyms.
Apply	Solve 5-10 MCQs using those words.
Revisit	Review the same items after 1 day, 3 days, and 7 days.

2. Topic-wise memory cues

Topic	Best memory method
List of Words	Word + meaning + context + related words
Confused & Misused	Pair the words and write one sentence for each
Phobias	Root -> object feared
Manias	Root -> object/behaviour of obsession
Prefixes & Suffixes	Break unfamiliar words into parts
Analogies	State the relationship in a full sentence
Synonyms	Build synonym families and note context
Antonyms	Learn contrast pairs
One Word Substitution	Group by people, places, beliefs, time, and descriptions
Idioms / Phrases	Attach each idiom to a real situation

3. Final exam checklist

- Do not select a synonym or antonym before identifying the exact sense of the word.
- For confused words, check meaning and grammatical role together.
- For analogies, name the relationship explicitly before checking options.
- For one-word substitution, make sure the answer satisfies the complete definition.
- For idioms, use the established figurative meaning, not the literal meaning.

4. Quick self-test prompts

Prompt	What should be recalled?
Give a synonym for "reluctant".	unwilling / hesitant
Give an antonym for "scarce".	abundant / plentiful
Fear of heights?	acrophobia
Excessive passion for books?	bibliomania
Prefix meaning "again"?	re-
A : B :: C : ?	Identify the relationship before answering
One who loves books?	bibliophile
Break the ice?	start a friendly interaction

Source note

The document follows the vocabulary section headings and page ranges shown in the supplied syllabus image. The individual words in the source pages were not provided as readable page text in the conversation; therefore, the examples and word banks in this guide are structured preparation material under those headings rather than a claim to reproduce the source pages verbatim.